others may have strengthened bottomlines in good times; they are now seen as too unreliable for difficult ones.

The nature of the Covid experience has also brought to fore concerns of transparency. Opacity can no longer be overlooked; it has real implications for the rest of the world. It was bad enough to be confronted with shortages and disruptions, worse that they could become pressure points. There are also worries that the financial distress caused by the pandemic could lead to new vulnerabilities. Consequently, strategic autonomy is now being debated as greater self-sufficiency, stronger partnerships and multiplicity of options, all of which are perceived as integral to risk mitigation. These can have geo-economic implications in the days ahead.

Behavioural aspects have also played their part. Stresses induced narrower definitions of self-interest and departures from collective endeavours. Few practised what they preached; some even stopped preaching altogether. Inadvertently, insights emerged on the interplay of culture, interests and values. Pluralistic societies remained more engaged with the world and solidarity was stronger between them. And those who saw the world also as a workplace, rather than just a marketplace, had a deeper interest in remaining connected.

Challenging as they may be, the essential realities of our times cannot be denied. Our globalization is deep and pervasive and will continue to shape activities and strategies. What Covid has brought out are some of the particular risks of its current incarnation. The task before us is to de-risk that, even while pursuing other objectives, including rapid economic recovery.

Every solution, however, also throws up new problems. The digital domain that is enabling so much delivery is raising issues of both privacy and security. That is even more so as AI gathers steam. Critical and emerging technologies are gaining in salience as revolutions in energy, mobility and communication unfold. Ensuring that newer supply chains do not enhance global vulnerabilities is of utmost importance. For India, this is the subject of engagement bilaterally with the US, trilaterally with Japan and Australia, and collectively with the Quad. The Trade and Technology Council initiative is a parallel exercise with the EU.

What is now clear is that the alarm bells set off by the Covid experience have brought into focus a larger challenge of ensuring trusted collaboration. The truth is that market economies and democratic societies offer a degree